# TSMC (TSM) Q3 2026 Post-Event Book

v20261016-0802-post | built 2026-10-16 08:02 SGT from locked pre-event book v20261014-1806 (integrity checked, not rewritten) | Not investment advice

## 1. Actual vs expected (FACT vs locked expectations)

| Metric | Guide | Consensus (locked) | OS (locked) | Actual |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Revenue US$bn | 44.6–45.8 | 45.64 | 45.2 | **46.72** |
| Gross margin % | 65.0–67.0 | — | 66.0 | **66.4** |
| Operating margin % | 56.0–58.0 | — | 57.0 | **58.7** |
| EPS/ADR US$ | — | 4.52 | 4.5 | **4.6** |

4Q26 guide: revenue $52.3–54.3bn (+14% QoQ at mid), GM 65–67%, OM 56.5–58.5%, FX 31.8. Call: FY2026 USD revenue growth now ~44% (2026 全年美元营收增长约 44%); 2026 capex reiterated $60–64bn; 2026–28 capex ‘even more significantly higher’ than prior 3 years; AI accelerator CAGR (2024–29, mid-to-high 50s%): ‘probably will be higher’ — no formal update; N2 capacity to more than double in 2027; A14 risk production 2027, volume 2028; Arizona Fab 2 volume production 3Q27 (slightly ahead); extra 3nm fab in Tainan (1H28); Overseas-fab GM dilution ~2% now, widening to 3–4% in later years; Consumer / price-sensitive segments challenged by rising component prices → ‘prudent’ 2027 planning; Advanced packaging: 5x reticle in production; 9x and 14x in development; GlobalFoundries interposer deal for back-end shortage.

## 2. Market reaction

TSM ADR -1.80% on 10/15 vs SOX -0.88% (relative -0.92pp); AMAT -3.72%, KLAC -2.43%, NVDA -1.84%. 2330.TW reacts in the 10/16 Taipei session (results came after the 10/15 close); not available at build time. Inference: fundamentals improved, but the price was set by a sector-wide de-rating and AI-chain de-crowding (equipment names fell for three sessions).

## 3. Classification & calibration

Locked rule → **BEAT** (revenue above the $45.8bn guide top). OS Brier 0.755 vs uniform 0.667 vs base rate 0.167. Error class: Probability Calibration (beat path

under-weighted at 30% despite a habitual-beat base rate), secondary Market-Reaction error.

## 4. Post-mortem & recalibration

Links held: AI demand (HPC +22% QoQ), N2/N3 ramp, guide. Mixed: gross margin (dilution 2%→3–4% from overseas fabs). Broke: stock reaction. Fix: earnings scenarios now split ‘beat + sector tailwind’ vs ‘beat + sector headwind’; beat prior for TSMC raised toward the base rate.

## 5. Valuation

Derived FY2026 revenue NT$5,594bn (+46.9% YoY) vs consensus NT$5,520bn (+1.3%) → consistent with consensus; DCF scenario structure unchanged (mechanical refresh only). Latest company model: v20261015-0757: Bear $134 / Base $350 / Bull $655（价格 $430.00）；v20261016-0756: Bear $132 / Base $341 / Bull $635（价格 $422.25）.

## 6. Falsifiers

October monthly revenue down MoM; 4Q GM < 65%; equipment keeps falling after the capex reaffirmation; 2330 sharply outperforming the ADR.

Source ledger, assumption register and full reasoning: see the Chinese edition §8–10.